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AQA · LEVEL 1 · ENGLISH READING

AQA Functional Skills English Reading Level 1

November 2021 - Reading Paper · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 30 / 30 Marks (100%) Pass Mark Guide: ~65%

Specification / Paper Code: AQA-Functional-Skills-English-Level-1-November-2021-Reading-QP

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

Verified by Tutor Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	*Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)*
Centre Name:	*Master Functional Skills (MFS01)*
Lead Tutor:	*Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk*
Edition:	*2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)*

- Complete Source Insert Included
- Built Cleanly on Empty AQA Question Paper
- Verified 100% Against Official AQA Mark Scheme

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AQA

Functional Skills Level 1
ENGLISH

Paper 1 Reading

Insert

The three sources that follow are:

Source A: a news report about cocoa bean picking
Source B: an article from a health magazine
Source C: a webpage from the British Heart Foundation

Please open the Insert fully to see all three sources

Source A

The bitter truth about chocolate and child labour

More than half a million tonnes of chocolate is sold in the UK each year. This Easter, Britons will eat their way through 80 million chocolate eggs. But not many of us know where the beans for our chocolate come from. In 2010, a reporter named Paul Kenyon investigated whether child labour in West Africa has been used to pick the cocoa beans for our sweet treats.

In Ghana he met 12-year-old Ouare, who was sold by his uncle and taken from his home to work as a cocoa picker. More than a year later, he had not been paid a penny for his work.

Aly, a farmer in Ivory Coast, relies on his eight-year-old brother and 11-year-old son to help harvest cocoa for large chocolate companies. Neither of the young boys goes to school.

Chocolate companies buy the cocoa beans to make their products. In 2010, the chocolate industry pledged to reduce child labour by 70%. Since then, the number of children working in cocoa production in Ghana and Ivory Coast has increased to almost two million.

Children work from 6 am until the evening and many sleep on wooden planks in rooms without proper toilet facilities. They are fed meagre helpings of the cheapest food and have no access to water. Some work may be dangerous, including climbing the trees to pick the pods. Children also use sharp knives to cut open the bean pods. Some of these children are as young as five.

From Cocoa Bean to Chocolate Bar



Source B

The Trouble With Chocolate

By Linda Mills



The average Brit will consume 7560 chocolate bars, 2268 slices of chocolate cake and 8316 chocolate biscuits in a lifetime. And an average person will drink over 3000 mugs of hot chocolate and eat 126 Easter eggs in their lifetime!

Chocolate is rich in sugar and fat, which appeal to our taste buds, but may not be good for us. Chocolate can brighten up our mood but there's also a risk of becoming addicted to it.

People may not know that chocolate also contains lots of caffeine, which may interfere with sleep. And, of course, every dentist will tell you that chocolate is bad for your teeth.

Is Chocolate Completely Bad For Us?

Modern life can be very stressful, causing some people to suffer from high blood pressure or heart disease. The antioxidants in dark chocolate can help to reduce blood pressure and protect against cancer. Studies have shown that chocolate can improve memory and help people to focus and it may be better for our health than other sugary sweets.

To many people, chocolate is comfort without words. But if you can't live without it, make sure you buy good quality chocolate and don't eat too much of it!

TOP TEN CHOCOLATE BARS 2020	
1. Dairy Milk (original) 2. Galaxy 3. Wispa 4. Twix 5. Mars	6. Snickers 7. Galaxy Ripple 8. Toffee Crisp 9. Bounty 10. Kit Kat



Source C

I'M ON A DECHOX™ | Why take part? | Surviving Dechox | Toolkit | Sign Up

Diseases of the heart and blood circulation affect around seven million people in the UK. So we are asking chocolate lovers to give up chocolate for one month to raise funds for our vital research.

Are you up for the **Dechox** challenge?

Chocolate isn't an essential part of a healthy diet but is a common indulgence in the UK. More than 40% of Brits confess to being chocoholics and most of them would really struggle to give it up.

Jo Pullin, **Dechox** Campaign Manager at the British Heart Foundation, said: "We know that it can be difficult to break our chocolate habits**.** **Dechox** is the perfect way to help break our habit whilst raising money for a good cause."

Tips for Success

Before **Dechox,** start reducing your chocolate intake so it's not such a shock when you stop completely. Get as many sponsors as you can to support you and set up your JustGiving pages ready for donations to the British Heart Foundation.

During Dechox

You will probably crave chocolate. To help with this, try out some of our delicious choc-free recipes and snack swaps. You are doing **Dechox** to help fund our life-saving research. So make sure you download our fundraising tools for support and ideas. Our survival kit will help you keep your hands off chocolate.

There is no point doing this in secret! Share your efforts on social media and include a link to your JustGiving pages. Your sponsors will want to know how you're doing. So share your progress badges with them. And once you've made it to the end of the month, make sure everyone knows you've conquered your **Dechox!**



END OF SOURCES

There are no sources printed on this page

Open out this page to see
Source B and Source C

There are no sources printed on this page

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Section A

Read **Source A** and answer **Questions 1** to **6**.

0 1 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
Child labourers in West Africa get sweet treats.		
Ouare was not paid for working as a cocoa picker.		
Many people know where the beans for our chocolate come from.		
Aly sends his son to school.		

Child labourers in West Africa get sweet treats.

Ouare was not paid for working as a cocoa picker. ✓

[2 marks]

0 2 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source A says: '…the chocolate industry pledged to reduce child labour'.

In this quotation the word 'pledged' means

A promised.
B wanted.
C failed.
D tried.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

0 3 **Source A** contains text and a picture showing the stages of making chocolate from cocoa beans.

What **extra** information does the picture contain about cocoa beans?

A Children often work in the cocoa bean industry.
B The cocoa bean pods need to be cut open.
C The cocoa bean pods grow on trees.
✓ **D** The raw cocoa beans are white. [Correct: D - 1 mark]

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

Question 1 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

Many people know where the beans for our chocolate come
□
from.
Aly sends his son to school. □
2 marks for all four correct
1 mark for three correct
[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

0 4 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
The young cocoa pickers work in safe conditions.		
The children have nowhere to sleep.		
The cocoa beans are picked for the chocolate companies.		
Nearly two million children work on cocoa bean farms in Ivory Coast and Ghana.		

The young cocoa pickers work in safe conditions.

The children have nowhere to sleep.

The cocoa beans are picked for the chocolate companies.

[2 marks]

0 5 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source A states: 'They are fed meagre helpings of the cheapest food'.

In this quotation the word 'meagre' means

A tasty.
B small. *[Correct: B – 1 mark]*
C several.
D unhealthy.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

0 6 What is the **main** purpose of the writing in **Source A**?

A To advise people not to buy chocolate.
B To describe how cocoa beans are harvested.
C To give information about the cocoa bean industry.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

Question 4 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

Nearly two million children work on cocoa bean farms in Ivory Coast and Ghana.

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

Read **Source B** and answer **Questions 7** to **9**.

0 7 From **Source B**, identify **one way** eating chocolate can **improve** your health and **one way** eating chocolate may **harm** your health.

0 7 . 1 Improves health _____

(The antioxidants can help) reduce blood pressure. Contains antioxidants (alone).

[1 mark]

0 7 . 2 Harms health _____

_____

[1 mark]

0 8 **Source B** says: 'To many people, chocolate is comfort without words.'

What does '…chocolate is comfort without words' mean?

A People worried about eating too much chocolate should talk about it.
B Eating chocolate makes people feel better without any talking needed.
C People enjoy eating and talking about chocolate.
D You shouldn't talk with your mouth full of chocolate.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

0 9 **Source B** has a subheading which says: 'Is Chocolate Completely Bad For Us?'

Why does the writer use a question mark (?) at the end of this subheading?

A She is worried that she is eating too much chocolate.
B She does not know how chocolate affects our health.
C She wants people to stop eating so much chocolate.
D She is telling us that she is going to answer this question.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

Question 7.2 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

- -
(Can cause) addiction. Rich in sugar and fat.
- -
(Contains caffeine which) may interfere Contains caffeine (alone).
with sleep.
- May not be good for us
-
Bad for your teeth.

[1 mark]

Question 7 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

Better than other sugary sweets.

(The antioxidants can help) protect against cancer.

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

Turn over for the next question

DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE
ANSWER IN THE SPACES PROVIDED

Do not write outside the box

Questions 10 and **11** refer to **Source A** and **Source B**.

1 0 Compare **Source A** and **Source B**.

Identify **two** ways these sources are **similar to each other**.

You could write about:

- what they look like
- how they are written
- what they are about.

[2 marks]

Both about chocolate / both are

1. Both sources

informative.

Both use statistics about how much chocolate people eat // talk about how

2. Both sources

much chocolate is eaten (in UK)

[2 marks]

1 1 Compare **Source A** and **Source B**.

Identify **two** ways these sources are **different from each other**.

You could write about:

- what they look like
- how they are written
- what they say.

[2 marks]

A is a news report; B is a magazine Any response which does not comment

Difference 1

article. on both texts eg B has a sub-heading but A does not.

A is negative about the way cocoa is

Difference 2

produced in some countries; B has quite a positive view of chocolate. which text the comments refer.

[2 marks]

16

Do not write outside the box

Section B

Read **Source C** and answer **Questions 12** to **17**.

1 2 Look at the language and structure used in **Source C**.

The main purpose of **Source C** is to

A inform people with heart disease that they should not eat chocolate.
B explain to children why chocolate can be so hard to give up.
C provide tips for success to people taking the Dechox challenge.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

1 3 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source C states: 'Chocolate …is a common indulgence in the UK.'

In this quotation the word 'indulgence' means

A treat. *[Correct: A – 1 mark]*
B ingredient.
C problem.
D gift.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

1 4 **Source C** states: '...start reducing your chocolate intake so it's not such a shock when you stop completely.'

By saying this the writer means:

A eat less chocolate at the beginning of Dechox.
B fill up with lots of chocolate before you start Dechox.
C stop eating chocolate completely long before you start Dechox.
D gradually eat less chocolate to get your body ready for Dechox.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

1 5 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
Seven million people in the UK did the Dechox challenge.		
Jo Pullin manages the Dechox campaign.		
JustGiving deals with the Dechox donations.		
A healthy diet should contain chocolate.		

[2 marks]

1 6 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **fact** or **opinion**.

	Fact	Opinion
40% of Brits confess to being chocoholics.		
Dechox is the perfect way to help.		
…our delicious choc-free recipes.		
Chocolate isn't an essential part of a healthy diet.		

[2 marks]

Seven million people in the UK did the Dechox challenge.

Jo Pullin manages the Dechox campaign.

JustGiving deals with the Dechox donations.

Range of appropriate information located and transcribed accurately. Relevance is clear.

Some appropriate information located, but insufficient and/or not relevant and/or inaccurately transcribed.

I mark Limited information located; relevance is unclear. Nothing written worthy of credit. Relevance very unclear

Indicative content

[2 marks]

Question 15 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

A healthy diet should contain chocolate.
2 marks for all four correct
[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

1 7 Your school or college is encouraging students to take part in Dechox. You have been asked to create a PowerPoint presentation about the Dechox challenge.

From **Source C**, make a list of **instructions** which should be followed **during** Dechox.

[3 marks]

10

END OF QUESTIONS

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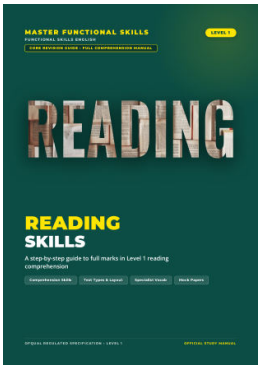
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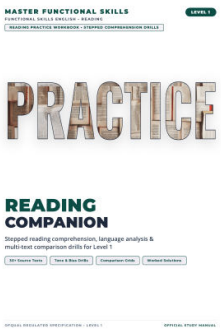


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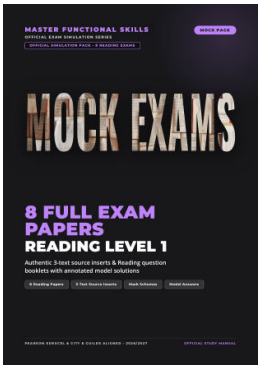


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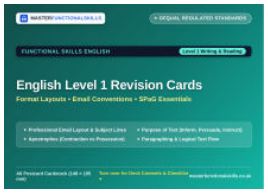


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